

 Yellow Level: Grade Level

Name: _____ Date: _____

Context: The Harlem Renaissance (c. 1920–1935) was a golden age of Black art, music, literature, and thought centred in Harlem, New York. Artists like Langston Hughes, Duke Ellington, Zora Neale Hurston, and Aaron Douglas weren't just creating beauty — they were arguing, through art, that Black life was worthy of celebration and respect.

ACTIVITY 1: PLANNING FRAME

Your Harlem Voice

Imagine you are a young artist in Harlem in 1925. Before you write, plan:

I am: (name, creative form) _____

What I create: _____

What I want the world to understand: _____

One word that describes my style: _____

ACTIVITY 2: WRITE IN FIRST PERSON

A Voice From Harlem, 1925

Write a poem, the opening of a story, or a monologue in the voice of your Harlem artist. Write in first person (I / me / my). Use vivid, specific detail — what do you see, hear, feel on the streets of Harlem?

Optional: sketch your artist, your creation, or a scene from Harlem

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ACTIVITY 3: WHAT DOES YOUR CREATION ARGUE?

Art as a Statement

The Harlem Renaissance artists weren't just making beautiful things — they were making an *argument*. What does your imagined creation say about Black life in 1925?

ACTIVITY 4: THEN AND NOW

Think about a modern musician, artist, or writer whose work makes a statement about identity or justice. How is what they do similar to what the Harlem Renaissance artists were doing?

Modern artist I'm thinking of: _____

 Mini Museum Connection

The **Harlem in Words** poetry workshop in the exhibition uses the same word categories that Harlem poets drew from: Dreams, Nature, Music, Emotion, Action, and Harlem. Build a poem and compare it to your writing here.

Visit: minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

Share with Your Family! Read your poem or monologue aloud at home. Ask: "Can you tell what argument I'm making — what I'm saying about who I am and what matters?"